ENG516 SHORT HANDOUTS MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG516) Teaching of Business Communication

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Lesson 06

NEEDS ANALYSIS-II

Topic - 031: Communication Needs

What is the purpose of a needs analysis in teaching a course?

The needs analysis is done to determine communication needs, business needs, and pedagogical needs of learners and teachers before teaching a course.

How can different communication situations affect communication needs?

Different communication situations give rise to different communication needs, and these needs can be traditional (like letters and reports) or modern (like internet, intranet, fax, instant messages).

How is needs analysis conducted for learners' communication needs?

Needs analysis for learners' communication needs involves finding out what learners need to do in English, such as using English with clients or writing assignments.

What tools can be used for needs analysis in communication?

Tools for needs analysis include questionnaires, interviews, observation, and commercially available tests.

Topic - 032: Main Priorities

What is the purpose of a placement test in assessing communicative competence?
A placement test assesses the current communicative competence of learners and helps place them with others having similar needs and ability.
What are the characteristics of a reliable placement test?
A reliable placement test should be valid, have face validity, authenticity, and be consistent in its results.
How do task-based assessments reflect real-life situations?
Task-based assessments use knowledge gained from the target needs analysis to design tasks that reflect real-life situations, such as giving presentations for business English learners.
Can you provide an explanation of how task-based assessments reflect real-life situations and what steps are involved in designing such assessments?
Task-based assessments are designed to reflect real-life situations that learners will encounter. For example, business English learners may be asked to give presentations if they are expected to do so in their job roles. Designing these assessments involves considering the target needs analysis and creating tasks that mirror the actual workplace scenarios.
Topic - 033: Pedagogical Needs
What are pedagogical needs based on?
Pedagogical needs are based on the teacher's style, experience, and needs, the learning environment, and the learning styles of learners.
What are some aspects of a teacher's role in addressing pedagogical needs?
A teacher's role can include being a trainer, coach, and consultant, adapting their teaching style, and being a reflective practitioner.
Topic - 034: Language Styles
How can learning styles be influenced by culture?
Learning styles can be influenced by the culture of learners, where expectations of the teacher's role may differ.
What is NLP, and how can it be useful to business English teachers?
NLP, or Neuro-Linguistic Programming, provides insights into communication skills, including non-verbal communication, active listening, and perception, which can be useful for business English teachers.
What is Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP), and how can it be applied in teaching business English and enhancing communication skills?
Neuro-Linguistic Programming (NLP) is a collection of techniques and theories that offer insights into how the mind works and how people communicate. NLP can be applied to teaching business English by improving communication skills, such as building rapport, non-verbal communication, and active listening, both for

teachers and learners.

Topic - 035: Business Needs

Why is understanding business needs crucial for a BE teacher?

Understanding business needs is crucial because it helps the teacher align the course with the sponsor's, company's, or department's expectations, ensuring that the training is worthwhile.

What are some key aspects a teacher should consider about the company when researching business needs?

The teacher should consider the company's product, market, size, and various business functions, and understand the hierarchy of the company.

Topic - 036: Main Priorities

How does a practical needs analysis help in course design?

A practical needs analysis helps in course design by considering factors like target situation analysis, communication needs, discourse, and means analysis, which includes facilities and learner placement.

What role does the sponsor play in determining course design?

The sponsor often has a clear idea of the learners' needs and might influence course design, as seen in formal reports and course design decisions.

Is needs analysis entirely objective?

Needs analysis is not entirely objective, as it involves decisions based on teachers' interests, values, and beliefs about teaching, learning, and language. It is both preparatory and ongoing.

Lesson 07

DESIGNING A COURSE-I

Topic 037: Aims

What is the role of a needs analysis in course design?

A needs analysis gathers information to inform course design decisions.

How does a needs analysis influence course design?

It influences the development of syllabus, materials, methodology, and evaluation.

What are the general aims of a Business English course?

A Business English course aims to achieve specific communication and pedagogical goals.

What is the connection between course aims and the needs analysis?

Course aims are derived from the information gathered in the needs analysis.

What is the difference between learner needs and learner wants in course design?
Learner needs are essential for effective course design, while learner wants might not always align with needs.
Explain the concept of a language-centered course design.
Language-centered course design focuses on teaching a restricted area of language related to specific needs.
What are the limitations of a language-centered course design approach?
It ignores the learner's needs and lacks flexibility in the learning process.
What is a skills-centered course design?
A skills-centered course design aims to develop learners' skills and strategies, not just impart linguistic knowledge.
How does a learner-centered approach view learning?
A learner-centered approach sees learning as entirely dependent on the learner's internal process and previous knowledge.
Why is a learning-centered approach considered more useful than a learner-centered approach?
A learning-centered approach maximizes the potential of the learning situation, considering both the learner and the target situation.
Could you explain the role of a needs analysis in the process of designing a Business English course?
Needs analysis is a crucial initial step in course design where information is collected to understand learners' communication, business, and pedagogical needs. This information guides the development of the course.
Topic 038: Setting Objectives
How do objectives differ from aims in course design?
Objectives are more specific and break down aims into smaller, measurable elements of learning.
Who might be interested in looking at course objectives?
Stakeholders and course sponsors may want to review course objectives.
What are some ways to create objectives for different learners and areas?
Objectives can be tailored for individuals/groups and various levels or areas of study.
What are some advantages of setting objectives for individual courses?
Individual course objectives allow for a customized program tailored to the trainee's needs.
How should objectives be treated in terms of flexibility during a course?
Objectives should be viewed as an ongoing, interactive process, open to adjustment and feedback.

Topic 039: Smart Objectives

What does SMARTER stand for in the context of goal setting and performance appraisal?

SMARTER stands for Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound, Evaluate, and Reevaluate.

What does it mean for an objective to be specific?

A specific objective is clear and answers the "Who, What, Where, When, Which, Why" questions.

Why is measurability important for objectives?

Measurable objectives allow for tracking progress and ensuring the objective's accomplishment.

What does it mean for an objective to be achievable?

Achievable objectives are realistic and attainable based on one's abilities and constraints.

Why is relevance important when setting objectives?

Relevant objectives lead to desired results and are connected to learners' current proficiency and organizational goals.

What does a time-bound objective include?

Time-bound objectives specify deadlines for when the objective should be started or completed.

Topic 040: Teaching and Business Objectives

How do teaching or training objectives differ from performance objectives?

Teaching objectives provide guidelines for teachers, while performance objectives specify what learners should do at the end of the course.

Why is it challenging to describe objectives for language and business communication skills precisely?

These skills can be difficult to quantify and measure, and business objectives may differ from teaching objectives.

What are the two ways to evaluate the outcome of a course?

The outcome can be seen in terms of what has been learned by the learners or the changes in the workplace or business results.

How should practical constraints be considered when setting objectives?

Objectives should be achievable, and potential variations in objectives due to different learners' needs should be taken into account.

Topic 041: Performance (Behavioral) Objectives

What are performance (behavioral) objectives used for in most Business English courses?

Performance objectives describe what learners are expected to do, under what conditions, and to what level.

Why is assessing learners' entry levels important?
It helps in course design and ensures that course objectives match learners' current abilities.
What are the challenges in assessing competence, particularly in fluency and effectiveness?
Assessing fluency and effectiveness relies on subjective judgment, making it difficult to have standardized criteria.
How can you assess entry levels in a Business English course?
Entry levels can be assessed through formal tests, accuracy, listening, reading comprehension, writing skills, and controlled speaking.
Topic 042: Program Outline and Trainee Briefing
What role does needs analysis play in setting course objectives?
Needs analysis provides input for setting course objectives.
What aspects need to be agreed upon in a course outline?
Length of time, type of input and output, ways of working, and the teaching approach must be agreed upon.
How can the length of time for course objectives be determined for individual courses?
The trainer can adapt the time based on individual learners' needs.
What is the difference between input and output in a course outline?
Input refers to materials used in the class, while output includes themes and activities for communication practice.
Who is responsible for providing materials in a training course?
Trainees may bring their materials or rely on the trainer to provide them.
What does "trainee briefing" aim to emphasize?
Trainee briefing stresses the importance of effort, commitment, and discipline in achieving competence in a foreign language.

Lesson 08

DESIGNING A COURSE-II

Topic- 043: Syllabus Design
What is a syllabus?
A syllabus is a document that outlines what should and will be learned in a course.
What is the purpose of a syllabus in education?
A syllabus provides a practical division of language, assessment, and activities,

gives confidence to teachers and learners, and acts as a visible goal for education.

Why is a syllabus important for commercial sponsors?

A syllabus reassures sponsors that their investment of time and money in education will be worthwhile.

What is the role of a syllabus in material selection?

A syllabus provides criteria for selecting appropriate texts and materials for the course.

How does a syllabus contribute to standardization in education?

Answer: A syllabus helps achieve uniformity in education, which is essential for institutionalized activities like education.

Topic- 044: Syllabus Components

What are content items in a syllabus?

Content items in a syllabus can be words, structures, topics, and process items like methods and tasks.

What information should a syllabus include regarding the course?

A syllabus should cover points such as aims, objectives, texts, activities, and evaluation methods.

How can a syllabus be organized?

A syllabus can be organized by topic, task, or around activities such as presentations and negotiations.

What are the key components of a syllabus, and how do they contribute to the structure and content of a course?

A syllabus comprises various essential components that collectively define the structure and content of a course. These components include aims, objectives, texts, activities, and evaluation methods. The aims and objectives set the overall goals of the course, while texts and activities determine the materials and tasks used for teaching. Evaluation methods are vital for assessing the success or failure in achieving the desired level of knowledge. The content items within a syllabus can be divided into two categories: content items, such as words and structures, and process items, like methods and tasks. The order and arrangement of these components in the syllabus are usually based on an explicit hierarchy, with easier and essential items addressed early in the course, followed by more challenging and less crucial aspects. The visible and comprehensive nature of a syllabus makes it a public document that is available for scrutiny by various stakeholders, including teachers, administration, parents, and sponsors.

Topic- 045: What is to be Covered and in what Order

What should a syllabus focus on in Business English teaching?

In Business English teaching, the focus should be on using language to perform tasks, not just talking about it.

Why should the language in a syllabus be learnable?
Answer: The language should be learnable based on the level of the learners, and learning must be achievable within the given time frame.
How does a syllabus structure the content to be covered?
A syllabus places selected language into manageable chunks, with content and order tailored to the learners' needs.
Topic- 046: Using a Grid
What is a useful technique for making a syllabus?
Using a grid or framework is a useful technique for making a syllabus.
What are the main components of a syllabus framework?
The main components of a framework may include linguistic competence, discourse competence, and intercultural competence.
Topic- 047: Organizing the Syllabus, Familiarity and Need
How can a syllabus be organized based on complexity?
A common approach is to start with simpler concepts before moving on to more complex ones in a syllabus.
How can a syllabus be organized based on familiarity?
It's often wise to cover familiar situations or topics before unfamiliar ones in a syllabus.
Why might a syllabus be organized based on learners' needs?
Organizing a syllabus based on learners' needs ensures that areas of higher priority are covered first.
Topic- 048: Sample Course Outlines
What are some types of syllabi?
Types of syllabi can include grammatical, lexical, situational, topic-based, functional/notional, and mixed or multi-strand syllabi.
What are some components of a sample course outline?
Components of a course outline may include topics, related areas, vocabulary, grammatical structures, and various learning activities.
What are the steps for designing a course in Business English?
Steps for designing a Business English course include identifying students' needs, defining program goals and objectives, syllabus design, selecting suitable material, course delivery, and program evaluation.

Lesson 09

DESIGNING A COURSE-III

Topic 049: Negotiating the Syllabus

What is the major advantage of negotiating the syllabus with learners?

Learners are more motivated and engaged because they have a say in course design.

When can the syllabus be negotiated during the course?

The syllabus can be negotiated at any time, even as the course progresses.

What are some practical issues that might influence the syllabus negotiation process?

Practical issues can include the availability of equipment, teacher expertise, and sponsor aims.

How can you generate the syllabus through learners on the first day of a course?

You can use a sheet where learners fill in what they want, what they don't want, and what the group wants from the course.

Why is getting learners to sign at the bottom of the page useful?

It reminds them that they are part of the course's success and reinforces their commitment.

What are the major advantages of negotiating the syllabus with learners, and how does it impact their motivation?

Negotiating the syllabus with learners has several significant advantages. It motivates learners because they actively participate in the course design process. Learners become more engaged, knowing that they have a say in shaping what will be taught during the course. This sense of ownership over the syllabus increases their commitment and enthusiasm for the course.

Topic 050: Using Learner's Input

Why is learner input crucial in course design?

Learner input helps the teacher understand the pace of the course and course content preferences.

How can a teacher gather learner preferences?

Teachers can provide questionnaires for learners to fill out about their preferences.

What does the syllabus generated from learner input typically represent?

The syllabus reflects an amalgam of different learner priorities and preferences.

Why might learner priorities change as the course progresses?

Learners may become more aware of their strengths, weaknesses, and evolving needs.

In what way are learners specialists in their area?

They bring expertise in their specific field, while the teacher is a language specialist.

How can a teacher gather and use learner preferences in course design?
To gather learner preferences, teachers can provide questionnaires that ask students about their specific preferences and objectives for the course. Once collected, this data serves as the basis for adapting and refining the syllabus, ensuring it aligns with the amalgamation of learner priorities and preferences.

Topic 051: Negotiating Priorities

How can questionnaires be used to refine course objectives?
Questionnaires can guide learners toward possible syllabus options and priorities.

What is the benefit of asking learners what they want to do during the week?
It helps in developing a syllabus that aligns with learner preferences and needs.

How can objectives be adapted for a particular class?
Content items can be changed, added, or removed based on learner needs and goals.

Topic 052: Using the Syllabus

Why does the use of a syllabus vary in different teaching contexts?
It depends on factors like available resources, teaching approach, and individual characteristics.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of a teacher-created program in affluent settings?
Advantages include flexibility and uniqueness, but disadvantages include the potential for gaps and lack of structure.

In what situations can a course book serve as the syllabus?
A course book can act as the syllabus, especially when it's the only available resource for students.

Topic 053: Managing the Logistics: Practical Considerations

What is a means analysis in course design?
A means analysis is a description of the training environment, including available equipment, facilities, and resources.

How can practical logistics impact course success?
Issues like equipment failure or a lack of resources can disrupt a course, regardless of the syllabus.

What should be considered during a means analysis?
Facilities, equipment, available time, materials, and learner availability should all be taken into account.

Topic 054: Instructions: Course Title, Venue, and Duration

Why are pre-course instructions important in syllabus design?
Good instructions provide relevant information and set the tone for learner motivation.

What does a "code of conduct" achieve when negotiated with learners?

It establishes rules that are more likely to be observed and helps build rapport between students and the teacher.

What practical considerations should be taken into account for course logistics?

Aspects like the training room setup, venue, and contingency plans should be thought through.

How can a "code of conduct" negotiated with learners impact the classroom environment, and why is it important to discuss it early on?

A "code of conduct" negotiated with learners can positively impact the classroom environment by establishing rules that are more likely to be observed. Discussing it early on, perhaps in the first contact class, helps break the ice and put students on a comfortable footing with the teacher and other participants. It contributes to a positive learning atmosphere.

Lesson 10

SELECTING AND DEVELOPING MATERIALS-I

Topic 055: Scope of Materials and Equipment

What is the scope of materials in teaching Business English?

The scope of materials includes stimuli used to develop knowledge of Business and Management skills, language forms, and communication skills.

What are some examples of materials used in teaching Business English?

Examples include audio, video, written material on business topics, reference material, and practice material.

What is the purpose of materials in a Business English course?

Materials serve as a means to extend knowledge and skills for learners.

What are the two types of materials mentioned in the lesson?

Raw materials and published materials.

How can teachers customize published materials for their learners?

Activities can be created according to learners' needs when using published materials.

Topic 056: Ready-made Materials

What are the advantages of using course books in Business English teaching?

Course books save teachers' work, provide a structured framework, and offer professional content.

What are the disadvantages of using course books?

Course books can become outdated and may not always fit the specific needs of learners.

What factors should teachers consider when selecting a course book?

Teachers should consider learners' specific requirements, teachers' priorities, and publishers' priorities.

What are the advantages and disadvantages of using course books in Business English teaching?

Course books are popular ready-made materials used in Business English teaching. They offer several advantages, such as saving teachers time and effort by providing a structured framework that can be followed systematically. This is particularly beneficial for less experienced teachers and those with limited time. Course books often include comprehensive teacher's guides, supplementary materials, self-study resources, audio and video components, which enhance the learning experience. They also provide learners with a window into the business world. However, course books have their disadvantages. They can quickly become outdated, and their content might not always be culturally appropriate in various contexts. Additionally, they may be based on different assumptions about language learning, which might not align with the specific needs of the learners. It's important to consider the different perspectives of those connected with course books, including learners, teachers, and publishers.

Topic 057: Authenticity: Real World/Teaching Purpose

Why is authenticity important when choosing course materials?

Authentic materials bring the real world into the class, making tasks realistic and motivating for learners.

What is the key issue related to authenticity in course materials?

The key issue is the balance between professional content and language-related authenticity.

What are some examples of authentic activities mentioned in the lesson?

Activities like reading newspapers and answering real-life letters are discussed as potentially authentic tasks.

Topic 058: Tailor-made Material – Generating/Adapting

Why might institutions or teachers choose to produce tailor-made materials?

Tailor-made materials are created to supplement course books or regular courses and can be designed to fit specific learning needs and contexts.

What are some advantages of creating tailor-made materials?

Tailor-made materials can be more specific and relevant to learners' needs.

What is the main focus during the preparatory stage of material adaptation?

During the preparatory stage, the focus is on assessing learners' needs, deciding

priorities, and analyzing language items.

Topic 059: Using Corpora

What are corpora, and why are they important for language teaching?

Corpora are collections of real language data, and they are important because they provide authentic language use examples.

How can teachers use concordances from corpora in their teaching?

Concordances allow teachers to focus on specific language features and analyze them in detail for classroom activities.

What benefits does using corpora offer in terms of language learning and teaching?

Corpora can help identify frequently used business terms and prioritize language items for more effective language courses.

Topic 060: Learner as Resource

Why might teachers involve learners in generating content for Business English lessons?

Involving learners allows for content that is relevant to their specific business context and needs.

What is the role of learners when using role-play in Business English teaching?

Learners can provide real situations from their workplace for role-play activities, making the learning experience more authentic.

How can teachers and learners collaborate to generate language points?

They can discuss and note key language points from real workplace materials, such as letters and emails, and use them for future reference.

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